

ART

The huge ash cloud from an Iceland volcano may be settling down, but the show IWA, a solo exhibition of 30 bronze sculptures, in small, medium and largescale, by sculptor Mrinalini Mukherjee is creating its own waves, mainly because her works are related to nature and the environment. Herbage and foliage converge, get entangled and disengage, giving way to various shapes, some of which have come up by sheer experimentation and some created consciously. "I work intimately with ideas, it is only later I get to analyse what I have done," says Mukherjee.

The artist, however, is not keen to provide explanations for her every work. She feels it is for the viewer to interpret art, which is why she has named her sculptures Forest Flame, Cluster and Outcrop. Through the procedure of weaving, firing and casting, she has formed spirals, loops and hollows, giving her bronze sculptures voluptuous

curves. There is a sensuous tactile quality to her work which is compelling.

Mukherjee, daughter of renowned artists Benode Bhari Mukherjee and Leela Mukherjee, studied painting at the MS University, Baroda, after completing school from Welham's, Dehradun. She then studied mural design under artists like K.G. Subramanyam. She began with figurative paints and then experimented with hand-dyed hemp structures which were called a marriage of craft and high art. Mukherjee treats her work as dynamic. "These sculptures are like living beings who grow and stay with you," she says. At Gallery Espace, Delhi. On till May 15

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

FILM REVIEW

GET EDUCATED: PAATHSHAALA
Bad Education

RATING ★ ★ ★ ★ ★

Director: Milind Ukey

Starring: Shahid Kapoor and Ayesha Takia



He's a teacher, so is she. They both meet in a school, Saraswati Vidya Mandir, run by Nana Patekar, doing his gruff Billy Goat act. He believes in good education but doesn't have the funds. This is one of those films where Shahid Kapoor throws his head back, stretches his arms out like a cut rate Shah Rukh Khan, and carries a guitar to look cool. Where children are either beguilingly cute or beseechingly pathetic. Where every teacher is a caricature, including the crazy Bengali geography teacher who walks around with a globe. There are reality shows where children are involved, students are stressed, and fees are hiked at random. Every hot button education issue has been touched upon. As an audition for Kapil Sibal, it is excellent. But this is not a proposal for a new school. It's a movie, right? Umm. **KB**

EXHIBITION

Art of Honour



WORK ON DISPLAY

What A show celebrating legendary Indian artist Syed Haider Raza. One of the founding members of the Progressive Artists Group and a Padma Bhushan, Raza has lived in France since 1950, though his works expand his strong ties with India, the country of his birth and origin.

When and Where On till May 2 at I&P Hutheesing Visual Art Centre, Ahmedabad.

by Nirmala Ravindran